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    android:text="@string/hello_world"
    android:layout_width="wrap_content"
    android:layout_height="wrap_content" />

```

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</RelativeLayout>
```

Before getting directly into building your RSS Feed Reader Android Application, it is best to understand a few elements which we will be using in our App.

ListActivity

ListActivity is a subset of the **Activity** class that displays items in the form of a list, by binding to a data source like an **Cursor** or **Array**. **ListActivity** holds the **ListView** object that can be bound to different data sources, and exposes event handlers when the user selects an item. In Android applications, **ListViews** are used to create views with lists of data. Lists are populated with data from data sources with simple arrays or with cursors.

In our RSS Reader App, we will be using **ListActivity**, instead of using an **Activity** to extend our main class from. The text to be populated in the list is available in the string array **listItems**. Similar to other activities the **onCreate()** method is also used and the first thing that needs to be done is call **super.onCreate**. Next set the **activity_my** file as the layout to display with **setContentView(R.layout.activity_my)**.

After all of this is done, the last thing you need to do is to populate the list. Now, in order to populate the list you need to create an **ArrayAdapter** and hand it over to **setListAdapter()**. The **ArrayAdapters** manages the **ListView** objects in an internal array. The **ArrayAdapter** constructor has to be passed 3 parameters, - the current class instance (**this**), the display layout to use for each list item, and the array of items respectively.

AsyncTask

The Android framework is strictly against performing long background tasks like network operations on the main UI thread and recommends performing such operations on a separate thread. To meet with this requirement, Android provides us with an abstract class - **AsyncTask**. **AsyncTask** lets us use the UI thread properly. It class allows us to perform background /long operations and show its result on the UI thread without manipulating threads and/or handlers.

Android is based on a single thread model and whenever a new android application is launched, a new thread is created. In our RSS Feed Reader